

weekly progress

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2026-06-13

1 WEEK3

1.1 What I read

SHapley Additive exPlanations (SHAP), a popular feature-based interpretability method, which can be seamlessly integrated into supervised ML models to gain a deeper understanding of their predictions, thereby enhancing their transparency and trustworthiness. (Ponce-Bobadilla et al. 2024)

Ponce-Bobadilla, Ana Victoria, Vanessa Schmitt, Corinna S Maier, Sven Mensing, and Sven Stodtmann. 2024. "Practical Guide to SHAP Analysis: Explaining Supervised Machine Learning Model Predictions in Drug Development." *Clinical and Translational Science* 17 (11): e70056. <https://doi.org/10.1111/cts.70056>.

1.2 What I did

- I have completed all path-related work. My code and the datasets used are located in the `python_codes` folder.
- All data has now been fully integrated. I am continuing with the data cleaning tasks.
- I am still learning how to use the new referencing method and the new approach to creating slides.

1.3 Questions

The way dealing with miss values in Patient Health Questionnaire-4 and Pre-existing health conditions

```
sdate, edate = "2021-02-10", "2021-10-18"
consent_gap_mask = (clean_df["endtime"] <= edate) &
(clean_df["endtime"] >= sdate)
phq_cols = [f"PHQ4_{i}" for i in range(1, 5)]
d1_cols = [f"d1_health_{i}" for i in list(range(1, 14)) + [98, 99]]
cols_to_fill = phq_cols + d1_cols
clean_df.loc[consent_gap_mask, cols_to_fill]
= clean_df.loc[consent_gap_mask, cols_to_fill].fillna("N/A")
```

To avoid losing valuable information by dropping these rows entirely, would it be acceptable to adopt an approach similar to Ryan et al. (Codes above is my own work based on their approach)?

1.4 Question 2

- Regarding model interpretability mentioned in your last email, is the MLP + SHAP approach unacceptably hard to interpret? I originally thought it was quite reasonable.
- If I need to switch back to RF and XGBoost, my extended work will only consist of adding the vaccine and case datasets. Do you think that would make the project too simple?

1.5 Plan for next week

- Complete data cleaning and preprocessing, and moving on to the modeling part.

2 WEEK4

2.1 Answers to the questions from recent emails

- Whether to expand the research scope I plan to allocate my time towards a more detailed explanation of existing framework. This includes detailing the specific reasons for data processing steps and improving the interpretation of the SHAP values.
- Missing data imputation I carried out a brief experiment after setting up the model. Moving forward, I will use the 'NA' string imputation strategy proposed by Ryan et al.

2.2 What I did

- Introduction of final report.
- Completed with the data cleaning, preporcessing, and data splittings tasks.
- Finished the defination of cross validation and evaluation of models.
- A small experiment: Compare the results of leaving structural missing values as `np.nan` against filling them with an "N/A" string category, or just remove these columns.

2.3 Experiment method

```
# String Version
model_df_str = model_df.copy()
model_df_str[exp_cols] = model_df_str[exp_cols].fillna("N/A")

#NaN Version
model_df_nan = model_df.copy()

#Drop version
model_df_drop = model_df.dropna(subset=exp_cols).copy()
```

For the `model_df` dataset, all systematic missing values within the time period have already been converted to null values.

2.4 Splite

This section illustrates the main calling sequence for splitting the data. Full implementation details are available in the `python_code` folder.

```
split_and_save(processed_nan, "exp_nan")
split_and_save(processed_str, "exp_str")
split_and_save(processed_drop, "exp_drop")
```

2.5 Gridsearch settings

```
grid_xgb = {
    'learning_rate': [0.05, 0.1, 0.2],
    'n_estimators': [100, 250, 500],
    'max_depth': [4, 6, 8],
    'colsample_bytree': [0.6, 0.8, 1.0]
}
xgb_clf = XGBClassifier(
    eval_metric='logloss',
    random_state=SEED,
    enable_categorical=True
)
```

2.6 Results

- Based on the results of the experiment, imputing 'NA' string did not affect the model's predictive performance, and removing specific features make changes to the predictions.
- Because most models to be evaluated cannot directly handle `np.nan` values, I will proceed with the string imputation strategy .

2.6.1 Model Results

`exp_nan`:{'colsample_bytree': 0.6, 'learning_rate': 0.05, 'max_depth': 8, 'n_estimators': 250}
Mean ROC AUC of cv:0.898 (0.002)

`exp_str`:{'colsample_bytree': 0.6, 'learning_rate': 0.05, 'max_depth': 8, 'n_estimators': 500}
Mean ROC AUC of cv:0.898 (0.002)

`exp_drop`:{'colsample_bytree': 0.6, 'learning_rate': 0.05, 'max_depth': 8, 'n_estimators': 500}
Mean ROC AUC of cv:0.899 (0.002)

2.7 Plan for next week

- Model tuning.
- Begin my presentation slides

- Keep working on my final report